

8.1 Export Quality

We've shown you how to present your model within SketchUp, but what if you want to send pictures of it to your friends or colleagues over e-mail? When you're done setting up the view you want to send, choose **File > Export > 2D Graphic** to create a picture of your model. Under the **Cancel** button in the dialog is the **Options** button, which gives you the **Export Image Options** dialog. Here, you can choose whether the size of the exported image is the same as it is on your screen (not a good idea if you want to print—use a larger resolution for that), and whether you want to anti-alias (smoothen) the edges. There's a huge difference in quality if your images are anti-aliased, so don't uncheck that option.



The Export Image Options dialog

A silly thing about exporting in 2D is that the resolution of the output image is proportional to your view size—so if you're working on a 4:3 monitor and want to export a 16:9 widescreen image, you can't do it by just keying in a resolution. Instead, you can use a simple workaround—resize your SketchUp window to get the wide view you want, and



The difference between an aliased and an anti-aliased image. Notice the jagged edges in the aliased image